Arthritis

Inclusion Toolkit

Symptoms

- Persistent joint pain, tenderness, and stiffness.
- Swelling or redness around the affected joints.
- Reduced range of movement and muscle weakness.

Age & Gender

- Most common in people over 40, though it can start at any age.
- Females are more likely to develop both osteoarthritis and rheumatoid arthritis.

Common myths

- It's not just the body wearing out with age.
- It's not just a few aches. It can cause severe, debilitating pain.
- It doesn't only affect the elderly.

Diagnosis

- GPs use blood tests to check for inflammation or specific antibodies.
- X-rays, MRI, or ultrasound scans identify joint damage and inflammation.

Treatment

- Painkillers and medicines that reduce inflammation help manage daily symptoms.
- Physiotherapy improves joint flexibility and strengthens the surrounding muscles.

How to help

- Provide equipment that reduces strain, like padded keyboards or upright mice held like a handshake.
- Allow for flexible breaks if they need to move or rest stiff joints.
- Be mindful that their mobility and pain levels can change daily.

This information isn't a diagnostic tool. If you recognise these symptoms in yourself or others, please contact a doctor.